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25 Years Journey of Educo Bangladesh

Promoting Child Rights and Wellbeing





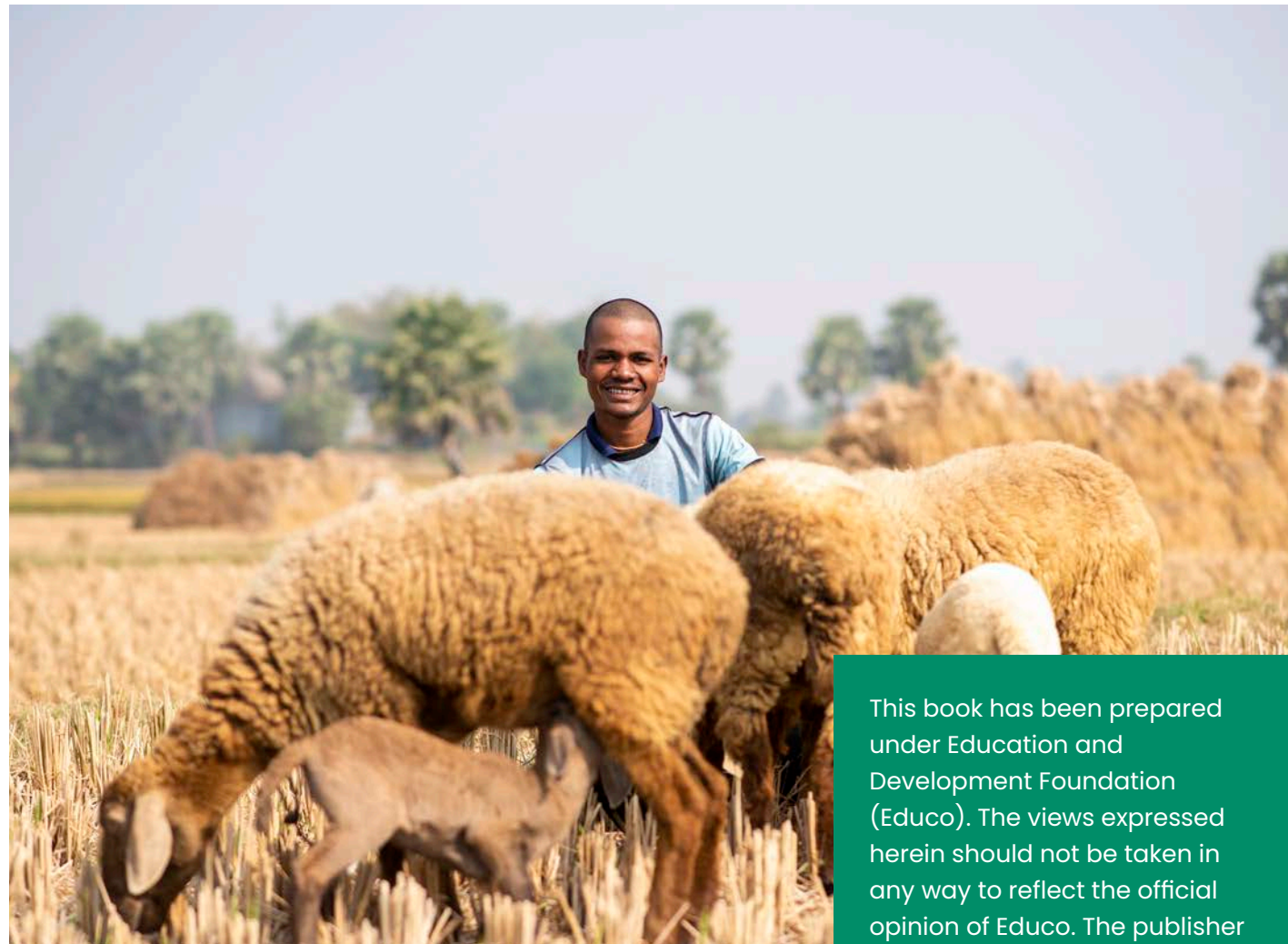


**25 Years
Journey of
Educo Bangladesh**



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Promoting Child Rights and Wellbeing



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Dedication

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to our esteemed well-wishers and friends, whose unwavering support and contribution have been influential in shaping our remarkable 25-year journey in Bangladesh.

As we reflect upon our path, we acknowledge that it has not been without challenges and obstacles. However, it is through the enduring encouragement and belief of our admirers and friends that we have persevered and continued to make a difference in the lives of children and communities.

To all those who have stood by us, offered their guidance, and shared our vision, we dedicate this publication to them. Your firm commitment and diligence to the cause of creating a just and equitable society for children have fueled our determination and propelled us forward.

Together, we have achieved milestones, touched countless lives, and fostered positive changes. Your belief in our mission and your support have been the driving force behind our success.

With deep gratitude and utmost respect, we express our sincere appreciation to our well-wishers and friends. This publication stands as a tribute to the collective impact we have made for the last 25 years.

Thank you for being a part of our journey and for supporting us to promote the rights and well-being of children. We are humbled and honored to have you by our side as we continue to strive for a world where every child can thrive and lead a life of dignity.



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Acronyms and abbreviations

CFA	ChildFund Alliance
ECCE	Early Childhood Care and Education
CbEM	Community-based Education Model
CBCPS	Community-Based Child Protection Systems
CBCPC	Community-Based Child Protection Committee
CA&Y	Children, Adolescents, and Youth
CBLF	Community-Based Learning Facilities
MPC	Multi-Purpose Learning Centre
AYC	Adolescent and Youth Clubs
A&Y	Adolescents and Youth
S4D	Sports for Development
AYC	Adolescents and Youth Club
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
G2P	Grow Green to Protect Planet
BTS	Breaking the Silence
ESDO	Eco-Social Development Organization
FIVDB	Friends in Village Development Bangladesh
IDEA	Institute of Development Affairs
MSEDA	Multi-purpose Socio Economic Development Association
NSS	Nazrul Smriti Sangsad
POPI	People's Oriented Program Implementation
SDS	Shariatpur Development Society
SKUS	Samaj Kalyan O Unnayan Shangstha

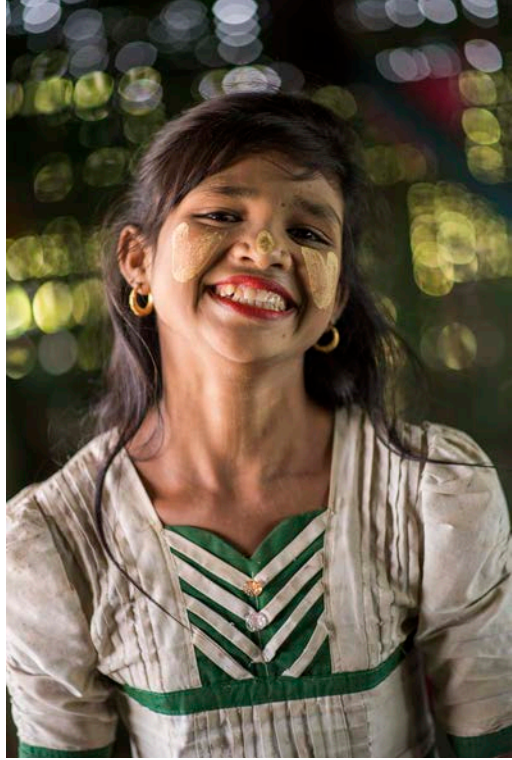
Acknowledgement

In our momentous 25-year journey, Educo has been blessed with an exceptional team of individuals, whose firm dedication and commitment have been the cornerstone of our success. We extend our deepest appreciation to our staff, implementing partners, volunteers, development partners, and supporters who have tirelessly championed the cause of education and the promotion of child wellbeing. Their persistent dedication, passion, and untiring efforts have been the compelling force behind Educo's impact. With their support, we have been able to make a tangible difference in the lives of children and communities.

As we celebrate Educo's 25th anniversary, we do so with profound gratitude and a renewed sense of purpose. We acknowledge that our achievements would not have been possible without the belief and contributions of our stakeholders. Together, we have broken down barriers, created opportunities, and empowered children to reach their full potential. We are humbled by the trust bestowed upon us by our stakeholders. Their belief in Educo's mission has fuelled our determination to continue shaping a better future, where no child is left behind.

Educo's 25-year journey is a demonstration of the transformative power of education in healing society's social challenges. As we celebrate this significant milestone, we reflect on the incredible achievements, the hurdles triumphed over, and the work that lies ahead. With gratitude and renewed commitment, we forge ahead, with confidence that Educo's impact will continue to reflect on the lives of countless children, empowering them to build a brighter and more inclusive future.

Editorial



Education has the power to transform lives, and for the past 25 years, Educo has been a driving force in this transformative journey. As we celebrate this milestone, it is a time to reflect on the tremendous contribution to build a better future for the children.

At the heart of Educo's mission lies the commitment to providing quality education, protection and empowering children, adolescents and youth. Through our innovative programmes, we have witnessed first-hand, the profound impact of education that can have an influence on individuals and communities. We believe that children who were once trapped in a cycle of limited opportunities have lacked to develop academically, economically and socially. For this reason, we work with them from the very beginning of their lives.

Educo's approach extends beyond the classroom. We have actively engaged communities, educating, and empowering them to take charge of their own development. By advocating for the rights of children and promoting inclusive practices, we have played a pivotal role in shaping a more equitable and inclusive society.

None of these achievements would have been possible without the strong partnerships we have forged along the way. Local communities, government bodies, civil society organisations, and development partners have been instrumental in supporting our work and amplifying our impact. Together, we have created a network of change-makers, united in the belief that every child deserves access to quality education and the opportunity to thrive.

In this publication of 25 Years of Educo, we strive to provide glimpses of our journey through visual stories. It is a celebration of the incredible achievements and challenges we have encountered along the way.

As we embark on the next chapter of our journey, we carry with us the lessons learned, the achievements celebrated, and the challenges that drive us forward. Together, let us continue to push the boundaries, break the barriers, and create a future where every child can unlock their full potential.



এম. এ. মান্নান, এমপি
মাননীয় মন্ত্রী
পরিকল্পনা মন্ত্রণালয়
গণপ্রজাতন্ত্রী বাংলাদেশ সরকার

বাণী



এডুকো বাংলাদেশ তাদের কার্যক্রম বাস্তবায়নে বাংলাদেশে ২৫ বছর পূর্ণ করেছে জেনে আমি আনন্দিত। এ উপলক্ষে আমি এডুকো বাংলাদেশের সঙ্গে যারা কাজ করছেন তাদের সকলকে আন্তরিক অভিনন্দন জানাচ্ছি।

‘এডুকো’ একটি স্পেন্ডিতিক আন্তর্জাতিক উন্নয়ন সংস্থা যা বাংলাদেশে ১৯৯৯ সাল থেকে শিশুদের শিক্ষা, সুরক্ষা ও সার্বিক উন্নয়নে সরকারের সহযোগী হিসেবে কাজ করেছে। এডুকো বর্তমানে বাংলাদেশের ১০টি জেলায় শিশুদের শিক্ষা, সুরক্ষা ও শিশুর কল্যাণে স্থানীয় জনগণ ও প্রশাসনের সঙ্গে কাজ করেছে।

এডুকো সরকারের সহযোগী সংস্থা হিসেবে ২৫ বছর ধরে কাজ করে যাচ্ছে এবং বাংলাদেশের মানুষের সুসময় এবং অসময়ে পাশে দাঁড়িয়েছে। কোভিডকালীন সময়েও তারা শত বাঁধা বিপত্তি অতিক্রম করে প্রত্যন্ত এলাকায় জীবনের ঝুঁকি নিয়ে কাজ করে গেছে এবং এডুকো বাংলাদেশ বর্তমানে রোহিঙ্গা কমিউনিটির সাথে কাজ করেছে শিশুদের শিক্ষা ও সুরক্ষার জন্য যা প্রশংসার দাবী রাখে। তারা প্রান্তিক জনগোষ্ঠীর অর্থনৈতিক উন্নয়ন, শিক্ষা, সুরক্ষা, কিশোর কিশোরীদের ক্ষমতায়ন, জেন্ডারভিত্তিক সহিংসতা প্রতিরোধে নিরলস ভাবে কাজ করে যাচ্ছে, যা সরকারের গৃহীত পদক্ষেপকে আরও বেগবান করেছে।

আমাদের লক্ষ্য ২০৪১ সালের মধ্যে বাংলাদেশকে একটি উন্নত ও সমৃদ্ধ দেশে রূপান্তর করা। আমি আশা করি এই লক্ষ্য অর্জনে এডুকো বাংলাদেশ তাদের কার্যক্রমের পরিধি আরও বাড়াবে।

এডুকো আরও এগিয়ে যাবে এবং মানুষের পাশে দাঁড়াবে এই আশা ব্যক্ত করে আবারও সংগঠনটিকে ধন্যবাদ জানাচ্ছি এবং উত্তরোত্তর সাফল্য কামনা করছি।



মোঃ শামসুল হক টুকু, এমপি
ডেপুটি স্পীকার,
বাংলাদেশ জাতীয় সংসদ ও সভাপতি,
শিশু বিষয়ক সংসদীয় কমিটি

বাণী



শেখ মোঃ মনিরুজ্জামান
মহাপরিচালক,
এনজিও বিষয়ক ব্যুরো
বাংলাদেশ

বাণী



আন্তর্জাতিক উন্নয়ন সংস্থা এডুকেশন অ্যান্ড ডেভেলপমেন্ট ফাউন্ডেশন- এডুকো শিশুবান্ধব সংস্থা হিসেবে বাংলাদেশে শিশুদের শিক্ষা, সুরক্ষা ও তাদের জীবন মান উন্নয়নে পথচলার ২৫ বছর পূর্ণ করেছে জেনে আমি আনন্দিত।

এডুকো যেনো এই ২৫ বছরের সফলতাকে আরো দ্রুত গতিতে এগিয়ে নিয়ে যেতে পারে এবং আগামীতে শিশুদের জন্য কল্যাণকর পরিবর্তন নিয়ে আসতে পারে সে জন্য সংস্থাটির সাফল্য কামনা করছি।

এডুকো বাংলাদেশ, তাদের এই ২৫ বছরের পথচলায় শিশুদের শিক্ষা ও অধিকার প্রতিষ্ঠায় দৃষ্টান্তমূলক অবদান রেখেছে। প্রতিষ্ঠানটি তাদের পথচলার এই দীর্ঘসময়ে বাংলাদেশের প্রান্তিক শিশুদের শিক্ষা, সুরক্ষা ও তাদের জীবন যাত্রার মান উন্নয়নে সরকারের সহযোগী সংগঠন হিসেবে নিরলসভাবে কাজ করে যাচ্ছে এবং অনেক উদাহরণ ও তৈরি করেছে। করোনা মহামারীর সময়ে তারা দুর্গত মানুষের পাশে থেকেছে এবং সেবা প্রদান করেছে। কক্সবাজারে রোহিঙ্গা শিশুদের শিক্ষা ও সুরক্ষা নিয়েও তারা একগ্রহিণীতে কাজ করেছে। বিগত সময় থেকে সংস্থাটি তাদের বিভিন্ন উন্নয়নমূলক কর্মসূচি- শিক্ষা, স্বাস্থ্যসেবা, শিশু সুরক্ষা, শিশুশ্রম নিরসন, কিশোর কিশোরীদের দক্ষতা বৃদ্ধি ও ক্ষমতায়ন এবং শিশুর প্রতি সহিংসতা প্রতিরোধে সরকারের গৃহীত বিভিন্ন পরিকল্পনা বাস্তবায়নে সহযোগী হিসেবে কাজ করে চলেছে। এই সংস্থাটি শিশুদের অধিকার রক্ষায় শিশু বিষয়ক সংসদীয় কমিটির সাথেও নিবিড়ভাবে কাজ করছে।

শিশুদের অধিকার নিশ্চিত করার জন্য এডুকো বাংলাদেশের অংশীদারিত্ব অনেক গুরুত্বপূর্ণ ভূমিকা রাখবে বলে আমি মনে করি।

আমি সংস্থাটির সাথে সংশ্লিষ্ট সকলকে আন্তরিক অভিনন্দন জানাই ও এর সাফল্য কামনা করছি।

(Signature)



এডুকেশন অ্যান্ড ডেভেলপমেন্ট ফাউন্ডেশন- এডুকো, বাংলাদেশে ১৯৯৯ সাল থেকে শিশু, কিশোর-কিশোরী এবং যুবদের উন্নয়নের লক্ষ্যে নিরলসভাবে কাজ করে যাচ্ছে। আমি জেনে আনন্দিত যে, প্রতিষ্ঠানটি এবছর রজত জয়ন্তী উদযাপন করতে যাচ্ছে। ২৫ বছর ধরে এডুকো বাংলাদেশ প্রান্তিক জনগোষ্ঠী, বিশেষত শিশুদের অধিকার আদায়ে কাজ করছে তার জন্য প্রতিষ্ঠানটিকে স্বাগত জানাচ্ছি।

শিশুদের সঙ্গে কাজ করার ক্ষেত্রে অনেক ভাবেই প্রতিষ্ঠানটি উজ্জ্বল দৃষ্টান্ত স্থাপন করতে পেরেছে। এই পথ পরিক্রমা অতিক্রম করতে গিয়ে সব সময় যে কাজের ক্ষেত্রটি সহজ ছিল তা কিন্তু নয়, অনেক বাঁধা বিপত্তি পেরিয়ে এডুকো তার এ জায়গাটিতে পৌঁছেছে এবং সামনেও এই উন্নয়নের ধারাবাহিকতা বজায় রাখবে বলে আমি আশা করছি।

এডুকো বাংলাদেশ ২৫ বছর ধরে বাংলাদেশের উন্নয়নে সরকারের সহযোগী সংস্থা হিসেবে ভূমিকা রেখে চলেছে। বাংলাদেশের প্রত্যন্ত অঞ্চলের সুবিধাবঞ্চিত শিশুদের মানসিক ও শারীরিক বিকাশ, সুরক্ষা, প্রাথমিক শিক্ষার গুণগত মান উন্নয়ন, শিশুশ্রম নিরসন, প্রাকৃতিক দুর্যোগ মোকাবেলা, জলবায়ু পরিবর্তন, যুবদের ক্ষমতায়ন এবং সামাজিক উন্নয়নের বিভিন্ন ধারায় কাজ করার ক্ষেত্রে এডুকোর সামগ্রিক অবদান অনস্বীকার্য।

এডুকো বাংলাদেশ তার উন্নয়ন কর্মকাণ্ডে আগামী দিনগুলোতে আরও দৃষ্টান্ত স্থাপন করতে পারবে এই প্রত্যাশা রইল এবং এর রজত জয়ন্তীতে সংশ্লিষ্ট সকলকে আন্তরিক শুভেচ্ছা ও অভিনন্দন জানাই।

(Signature)



Antoni Isac
President
Educo

Message



The celebration of Educo Bangladesh's 25th anniversary is a unique opportunity to highlight the magnificent work they have carried out over the years. I hope to have the opportunity to get to know first-hand the communities we support, our programmes and the cohesive, committed and extremely involved team delivering our services daily in the field.

We are celebrating this 25th anniversary after a difficult few years, marked in particular by the COVID-19 pandemic. This health crisis forced us to adapt to the new situation, identify new needs and threats to the communities we support, and in many cases change the way we work. I can proudly say that we have emerged stronger from the crisis that Educo Bangladesh has been an example of audacity, perseverance, and strength. Our firm commitment to children and adolescents drives us to continue fighting to ensure that in this complex context their education was not interrupted, and we have worked side by side with children, their families, their communities, local administrations, and our partner organisations to promote children's rights and wellbeing.

Our achievements are the merit of a team of Bangladeshi men and women, who have a deep understanding of the reality of the country, and who have been able to establish links and alliances that have enabled us to build and grow. We have achieved an excellent balance that allows us to drive positive change in close collaboration with local communities and leaders.

Together we are stronger. One example of this is our work in the Cox's Bazar refugee camp. Over the years, in partnership with ChildFund Alliance, we have built a strong network with other organisations and agencies that has resisted extreme weather events, the pandemic and other adversities. Our team on the ground has shown that in the most difficult of times, they were able to do their best.

I am confident that this success will continue. I would not want this to sound like a well-intentioned or gratuitously optimistic statement. There will be difficult times ahead and Bangladesh is undoubtedly suffering from the consequences of the climate crisis. However, I am convinced that we will respond to this challenge with the same ingenuity and boldness that we showed during the pandemic.



Pilar Orenes
CEO
Educo

Message



Educo Bangladesh is celebrating its 25th anniversary. Congratulations for making it this far and for your commitment to the children of your country. As CEO of a children's NGO present in 14 countries, I can assure you that Educo Bangladesh has played a key role and that we learn from their team on a daily basis.

I have been fortunate enough to travel to Bangladesh and learn first-hand about our projects that support the education of working children; our education and protection programmes in the Tea Gardens and Haor areas; and the situation in the Cox's Bazar refugee camp.

Over the years, Educo Bangladesh has been able to cultivate relationships based on mutual respect and trust with a variety of actors: local administrations, local organisations, as well as families and the educational community, in order to contribute to improving the rights and wellbeing of children, working alongside each and every one of them. There is no doubt that respect and trust are earned day by day, by demonstrating professionalism, accountability and listening to all the parties involved.

The COVID-19 pandemic took away the livelihoods of many families, and this increased the number of children in the labour market. A good example is how we have worked together to improve the situation of working children. We are convinced that education changes lives and gives access to better job opportunities.

I was shocked when I first visited at the world's largest forcibly displaced people's camp situated in Cox's Bazar. Witnessing harsh reality of the camp, I realised the crucial need for uninterrupted education and safe spaces for children. Educo Bangladesh prioritises education in emergency, ensuring nurturing environments for learning and play. We remain devoted to supporting the vulnerable Rohingya community.

I would like to end by thanking the Educo Bangladesh team for their dedication. In a complex and undoubtedly challenging phenomena, they are the best example of the fact that behind a success story there are committed and determined people who always dare to go one step further, sometimes taking a step that no one else has taken before. To all of you, thank you and congratulations.



Guiomar Todó
Deputy CEO
Educo

Message



The 25th anniversary of Educo Bangladesh reaffirms my conviction that our work does matter and that, despite all the difficulties we may have had to face, the outcome is very positive. It has not been easy, but Educo Bangladesh has grown in the face of adversity and is now ready for the challenges ahead.

Over the years and thanks to a close relationship with local administrations and partners, we now reach remote areas of the country and provide quality education to children who otherwise would not have access. We are promoting programmes aimed at the first five years of children's lives, which are crucial for their development. Even at the worst times of the COVID-19 pandemic, we have stood by the Rohingya community in Cox's Bazar.

I would also like to highlight the Aloy Alow project, through which we aim to ensure that all children in the Tea Gardens and Haor areas have access to quality early childhood, pre-school, and primary education. We also work to increase parents' knowledge about the health and nutrition of children and their families.

Since the project began, we have built new schools and nurseries, as well as rehabilitated existing ones. We also prevent the transmission of waterborne diseases among the children by facilitating awareness campaign and building wells and latrines.

We believe in the importance of actively listening to children, young people, their parents, educators, community leaders and local administrations. Alongside local organisations, we engage in dialogue on the best ways to address serious problems facing children in the country, such as corporal punishment, sexual harassment, trafficking, child marriage, dowries, lack of education and child labour. We do this in the belief that ensuring a safe environment for children and guaranteeing them a quality education will transform their lives, as well as the lives of everyone around them. We believe that education heals. This is our motto in the 14 countries we work in.

In 2022, Educo Bangladesh supported 21 projects, which reached 65,222 children and adolescents, 55,414 adults and 392 schools. These impact figures fill me with pride and motivate me to continue.



Francisco de Asís Benítez Salas
Spain Ambassador to Bangladesh

Message



The Spanish Embassy in Dhaka is pleased to commemorate the 25th anniversary of Spanish NGO EDUCO Bangladesh, which is a well-known and globally acclaimed development and humanitarian organization with deep historical bonds with Bangladesh.

May I recall with gratitude the fundamental role played by Educo in its 4 offices in Dhaka, Cox's Bazar, Sreemangol and Satkhira since its establishment in Bangladesh in 1999 as well as its strong adherence to the principles of equity, respect, tolerance and social commitment.

I am well aware of the tireless effort and work carried out by Educo in different fields including child labour elimination, climate change adaptation, disaster risk management and combating gender based violence. The Spanish Embassy thanks Educo for its commitment in strengthening education in Bangladesh including the empowerment of adolescents, who represent the bright future awaiting this country.

I take this opportunity to pay a special tribute to Mr. Abdul Hamid, Country Director of Educo Bangladesh, who I know very well and whose work and sacrifice for the social development of Bangladesh I value very high. The Integrated Program in Tea Garden and Haor areas remains a good testimony of that.

For the past 25 years till date, Educo continued to play an active role in the social development of Bangladesh and by doing so it has provided unwavering support in the recent past to provide a humanitarian response for the Rohingya Community.

I wish EDUCO all the success in the years to come and I extend my sincere gratitude on the occasion of this silver jubilee.



Meg Gardinier
Secretary General, ChildFund Alliance



As a network of 11 members advocating for the wellbeing and rights of children in 70 countries, ChildFund Alliance is committed to engaging children, families, and communities to create lasting change. Our member, Educo—an NGO working in 14 countries—is especially focused on ensuring a child’s right to quality education, protection, and empowerment of adolescents and youth.

Since 1999, Educo has been working in Bangladesh for the welfare of children and the fulfilment of their right to education, particularly those who live in situations of vulnerability, poverty, being hard to reach, or a lack of opportunities. With programmes in 10 districts in the country—home to 170 million people in south Asia—Educo Bangladesh is working with children to promote just and equitable curricula in partnership with 15 local NGOs.

Through their programming, Educo and the partners have helped establish daycares, early childhood development centres, libraries, and community-based learning centres to enhance children’s reading skills. A community-based child protection mechanism has been established to fight against the risks they usually encounter, like early marriage, corporal punishment, gender-based violence, dropping out of school, and so on. Through hundreds of adolescent and youth clubs, adolescents and young people can learn to empower themselves through life skills and

vocational training, job linkage, sports and cultural activities, awareness campaigns, etc.

Educo Bangladesh is also implementing youth-led and community-managed climate change projects in the most vulnerable coastal regions of the country. Moreover, to help eradicate child labour, Educo Bangladesh partners with families, teachers, employers, local governments, and service providers to eliminate hazardous work for children.

Since 2019, Educo Bangladesh has had a strong presence in Cox’s Bazar; along with the support of other ChildFund members, they continue to implement a range of initiatives to ensure children in Camps and Host communities in Cox’s Bazar can continue to access their right to education and protection.

As Educo Bangladesh marks 25 years of programming in this south Asian country, ChildFund Alliance wishes to recognize their commitment and service to those impacted by the world’s ongoing crises. As children and families must put their lives on hold due to situations including conflict, climate crises, hunger, and poverty, we are grateful for the work of Educo Bangladesh to help children, families and communities rebuild and reestablish their lives.

Meg Gardinier

Message



Abdul Hamid
Country Director
Educo Bangladesh



It fills my heart with immense joy and pride to address this momentous occasion—the 25th anniversary of Educo in Bangladesh. Now, we gather together to commemorate, reflect upon, and express our deep gratitude for the extraordinary journey we have embarked upon hand in hand.

Over the past quarter-century, Educo Bangladesh has remained devoted in its mission to transform lives through education, protection, and empowerment. Our untiring dedication has focused on delivering high-quality education, empowering communities, and fostering persistent change for children and their families throughout Bangladesh.

Throughout this incredible journey, we have borne witness to countless tales of triumphs and achievements. We have observed children who were once deprived of opportunities are now thriving economically and socially. We have witnessed communities uniting to construct stronger, more inclusive societies. These remarkable milestones owe their existence to the tireless dedication, passion, and toil of each and every one of you.

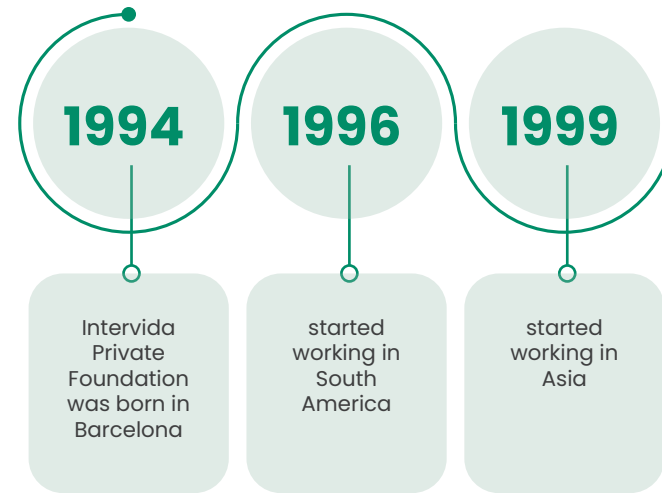
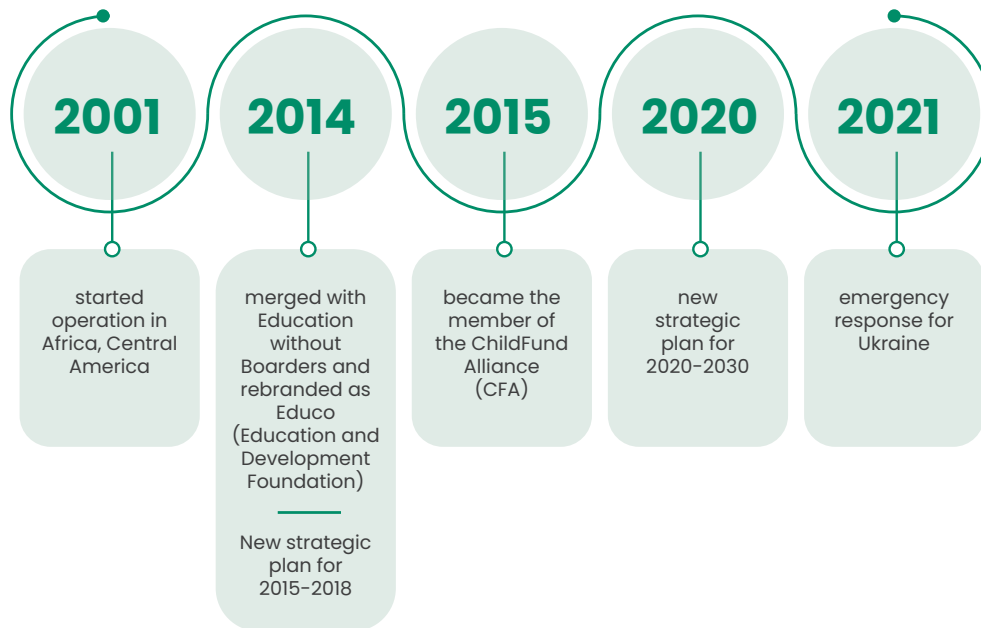
As we rejoice in this significant milestone, let us take a moment to acknowledge the challenges we have overcome. We have encountered numerous obstacles along the way, yet it is our collective spirit and firm commitment that has driven us forward. Together, we have showcased that education possesses an indomitable power, capable of conquering adversity and transforming lives.

Despite the progress we have achieved, there are still many children in Bangladesh who remain deprived of access to quality education, protection, and gender equality. Poverty, discrimination, and other systemic barriers persist, impeding their growth and development. As we forge ahead, let us renew our commitment to leaving no child behind, extending our reach to the most marginalised and vulnerable, and fostering an equitable society for all.

Hamid

Message

History of Educo



Bangladesh



Working in 14 countries in Asia, Africa, Latin America and Europe



Europe

Spain

America

Bolivia
El Salvador
Guatemala
Nicaragua

Africa

Benin
Burkina Faso
Mali
Niger
Senegal

Asia

Bangladesh
Cambodia
India
Philippines



Who we are

Educo is a global development and humanitarian NGO headquartered in Barcelona, Spain, with a 30-year rich history of working in 14 countries. Our mission revolves around collaborating with children and their environments to foster a just and equitable society that safeguards their rights and well-being. Our vision is a world where all girls and boys have access to educational environments and fully enjoy their rights and a dignified life. We strive to create opportunities for children, youth, families and communities across the globe.

The organisation was **rebranded as Educo in 2014**, formerly known as **INTERVIDA**. We are a member of ChildFund Alliance (CFA) which is a network of 11 child-focused development and humanitarian organisations present in 70 countries, that helps nearly 23 million children and their families to overcome poverty.

As we reflect on our journey, we remain committed to our mission of empowering children and communities worldwide. Together, let us continue working towards a brighter future, where every child's rights are respected and their well-being is ensured.



We have a mission

**We work with children
and their environment
to promote just and
equitable societies
that guarantee their
rights and well-being.**



We have a vision

A world where all girls and boys have access to educational environments and fully enjoy their rights and a dignified life.



We work for children



We work so that all children fully enjoy their rights and a dignified life. We focus on the right to education for children because we believe that this is the beginning of all possible changes. Because education heals and offers new opportunities.



Educo in Bangladesh

As a right-based organisation, Educo plays a catalyst role in improving the living conditions of vulnerable populations, especially children, by acting upon the causes of poverty and inequality. In Bangladesh, Educo has been implementing activities for local communities directly since 1999. Since then, Educo Bangladesh works with children and their environment to promote just and equitable societies that guarantee their rights and well-being.

Over time, our efforts have expanded to cover broader geographical regions. Currently, Educo Bangladesh is engaged in a diverse range of development and humanitarian projects in ten districts. These projects are made possible through the generous support of various private and institutional donors such as Sponsorship, KOICA, EU/UNOPS, Child Fund Alliance members, ADEY, MANGO, NZMFAT, AECID, and so on. These initiatives are being carried out across different districts of Bangladesh, addressing the unique needs and challenges faced by the local communities.



From 1999 to 2020

Since its establishment in 1999, we have been dedicated to promoting child rights, education, and protection while fostering community engagement to build the enabling environment of the children's overall development. Throughout our history, we have been committed to apply an integrated approach that addresses multiple dimensions of children's well-being and empowers communities to thrive.

By establishing schools and educational programmes in underserved areas, Educo has played a pivotal role in expanding access to education for countless children. Besides, through various child protection programmes, we have worked tirelessly to safeguard children

from exploitation, abuse, and neglect. By collaborating with local communities and authorities, we have been successful in creating child-friendly environments where children can grow and thrive without fear.

Moreover, recognising the significance of family support in a child's wellbeing, we have engaged with parents to ensure their active involvement in their children's education and well-being. Moreover, we extend support to parents in improving health and nutrition for their families. Through skill development and agricultural programmes, we empower parents with livelihood opportunities that contribute to their economic independence and stability.



From 1999 till 2020, It operated 37 schools with sponsorship/private fund that endeavoured to reach a global standard of its kind. All institutions have now been transferred to the community or similar organisations for the purpose of utilising the community's strength to create a sustainable impact. Educo is now investing in programmes focused on Education, Protection and Empowerment to support its core education programmes.

In 2017, Educo Bangladesh started first ever partnership with external funding support, named EARTH Project in Tea Garden and Haor areas of Moulvibazar district. From learning of EARTH Project and addressing the needs of the population of Tea Garden and Haor areas, we have started a multi-year and multi-sectoral integrated development project, named, ALOY ALOW Project in 2019.



In the humanitarian context, Cox's Bazar district has been focused on addressing child protection, education and gender-based violence issues – especially with the Rohingya and host communities. We have a strong existence in the Rohingya camps since 2019. In 2022, we worked with the Rohingya people in Bhasan Char too.

Educo had been implementing education and development initiatives in the districts of Dhaka, Narayanganj, Gazipur, Mymensingh, Maulvibazar until the year 2020.



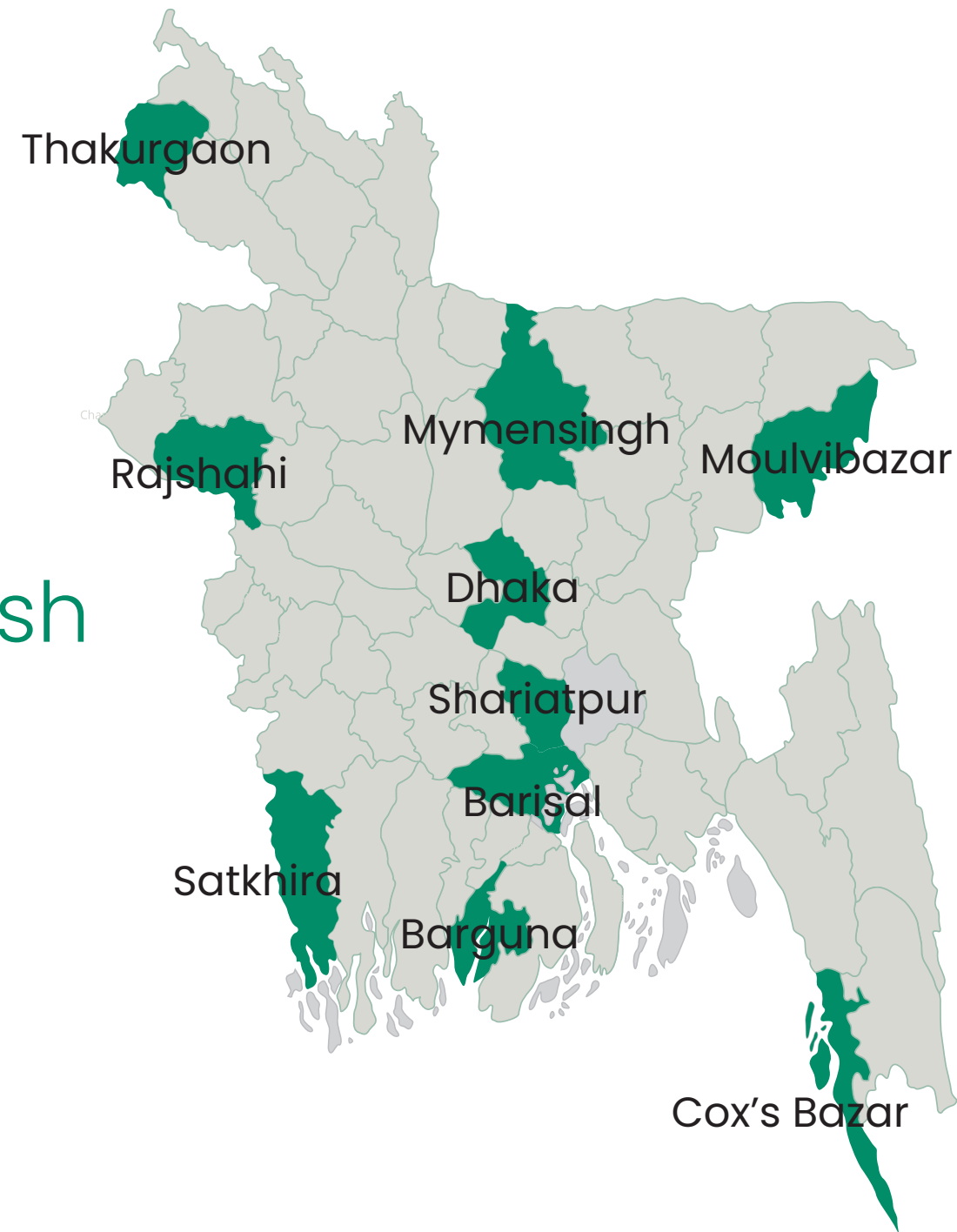
2021 onwards

In 2021, there was a significant strategic transition of Educo from direct implementation to a partnership approach. Educo has made significant advances in education, protection, and governance, with a focus on the rights and welfare of children, through partnerships with local organisations and communities.

Currently, Educo Bangladesh is implementing programmes in 10 districts in partnership with 15 local NGOs in order to ensure localisation and sustainability.



Educo Bangladesh footprint



Our works

For the past 25 years, anchored in a child well-being approach, we firmly believe in the collective effort required to realise children's rights and provide them with opportunities to thrive.

We believe that the notion of education heals lies at the heart of our endeavours, starting from early childhood to embracing the transformative journey through various stages of life. We advocate for a universal, free, and publicly funded education system that upholds diversity, combats inequality, and empowers children to grow as individuals. Central to our

vision is the creation of safe spaces where youth and adolescents can learn, share, and progress while feeling supported and secure.

In our firm commitment to child rights, we actively work towards promoting child protection and gender equality. Besides, we work for eliminating child labour and child marriage, other social ills that hinder children's well-being. We lend our support to humanitarian crises, particularly through Disaster Risk Reduction, and Rohingya Response, ensuring the protection and resilience of communities in times of crises.





Safe, equitable and quality education

Promoting safe, equitable, and quality education has always been at the core of Educo's mission. Over the past 25 years, we have tirelessly worked to ensure that children and adolescents in the most vulnerable communities have access to education that is not only safe but also of high quality.

Our education programme particularly caters to children from disadvantaged backgrounds, including those from tea-garden worker families, indigenous communities, and those with limited opportunities. Through our efforts, we strive to create a nurturing environment where every child can flourish and thrive.

Major component under this programmatic area

- **Education and care in early childhood**
- **Safe, inclusive and innovative educational processes**
- **Education in natural disasters**



Education and care in early childhood

Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) holds a paramount position in Educo's comprehensive education programme, spanning the crucial years from 3 to 5. Recognising its significance in shaping children's learning, health, behaviour, and overall happiness, we strive to foster their full potential and facilitate healthy growth and development. While many research initiatives and programmes rightly focus on the long-term impact, we, at Educo, emphasise the present effects and the fundamental right of working with these young minds.

Presently, our ECCE & Pre-primary project extends its reach to **5,517** young children across Mymensingh, Thakurgaon, and Moulvibazar districts, encompassing **144** centers/classes. By safeguarding their rights from the early stages, our project aims to ensure the holistic development and well-being of these young learners. We are also working in 11 Day care in tea garden, Moulvibazar.



Safe, inclusive and innovative educational processes

By extending our support, we aim to accelerate educational programmes, ensuring every child's right to receive a quality education and enabling a smooth transition to the next educational level. We prioritise the participation of children from disadvantaged backgrounds, including those from tea-garden worker families, indigenous communities, and those with limited opportunities.

Our community-based Education Model (CbEM) stands as evidence to our commitment. Through this approach, we have reached nearly **36,700** children in Dhaka, Mymensingh, Thakurgaon, and Moulvibazar districts, operating across **132** primary schools among them **122** Government Primary Schools and **10** Community Schools. CbEM serves as a lifeline for children facing vulnerabilities and learning challenges, offering them the opportunity to thrive. Moreover, we are working in **55** secondary schools with **21,00** adolescents.



Education in natural disasters

We prioritise the development of community resilience through school-based Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) initiatives. In collaboration with 60 selected schools and communities in Shariatpur, Barguna, and Barisal, we are actively exchanging valuable information and equipping them with essential tools.

Till now, these 60 schools have successfully developed comprehensive school safety plans, ensuring preparedness in the face of potential disasters. Moreover, each school has established a dedicated DRR task force, composed of passionate youths committed to enhancing DRR capacity within their schools and neighboring communities. Their collective efforts aim not only to promote school safety but also to minimise disaster loss and damage.

We are proud to report the active involvement of approximately **1,752** adolescents and youth (A&Y) in these crucial activities. Their engagement in DRR activities demonstrates their commitment to creating a safer and more resilient environment for themselves and their communities.

By integrating DRR practices into the education system, we are fostering a culture of preparedness and resilience. Through knowledge-sharing, capacity-building, and collaborative efforts, we are empowering schools and communities to effectively respond to and mitigate the impact of disasters.





Protection against violence and exploitation

Violence is omnipresent in the lives of children and adolescents. Globally, up to 1 billion children, half of the world's children (age 2- 17), have experienced physical, sexual or emotional violence or neglect. Violence against children and adolescents occurs in all countries, in all settings and at all stages of development; it can be perpetrated by variety of actors and in multiple contexts, including in digital contexts where it is growing exponentially. But all children and adolescents have the right to be and feel protected. Educo works towards the full enjoyment of the rights to protection from all forms of violence of the child, in line with the Convention on the Rights of the Child.

Under this programmatic area our major interventions are

- › **Protective and positive treatment family and community environments.**
- › **Combating the worst forms of child labour and exploitation**
- › **Combating gender-based violence**
- › **Protecting children in humanitarian crises**



Protective and positive treatment in family and community environments

Throughout our 25-year journey in Bangladesh, Educo has been focused on strengthening the community-based child protection system and promoting the rights of children in the intervention districts. We have worked persistently to establish Community-Based Child Protection Systems (CBCPS) and provided continuous support to Community-Based Child Committee (CBCPCs). These CBCPCs have been empowered to develop their own action plans and have been capacitated to effectively carry out their vital roles.

The CBCPCs play a crucial role in raising awareness and preventing various forms of child maltreatment, including child marriage, physical abuse, child labour, and corporal punishment and so on. Their tireless efforts contribute to safeguarding the well-being and rights of children in their communities. Our long-term vision is to ensure the sustainability of these CBCPCs and integrate them into the national child protection system, creating a comprehensive framework for child protection at a national level.



Combating the worst forms of child labour and exploitation

We have been working towards combating and eradicating hazardous forms of child labour in marginalised urban slums and coastal areas.

We have focused on Mohammadpur and Adabor Thana in the city of Dhaka, as well as Sadar Upazila of Cox's Bazar and Shyamnagar Upazila of Satkhira. Our efforts have yielded significant results.

To date, we have provided basic primary education to more than **1,000** working children, successfully mainstreamed around **200** children into regular schools, and equipped around **100** children with vocational training. To raise awareness within communities, we have established **08** active Community-based Child Labour Monitoring Committees. These committees play a crucial role in educating the community about the detrimental impacts of child labour and the significance of education.





Education heals child labour

Despite her tender age, Sumaiya Akter has learned to navigate adversity with firm determination. She spends her days working in the dry fish village, tirelessly contributing her efforts from morning till evening. This arduous routine has become her only option to supplement her family's income and secure their daily sustenance.

Sumaiya's family has been grappling with financial difficulties ever since her father's tragic accident three years ago, which left him without his right hand and unable to work. With her mother shouldering the burden of being the sole breadwinner, Sumaiya has stepped up to help ease the family's financial struggles.

Education, once a luxury out of reach for Sumaiya, suddenly became a glimmer of hope. It was on a sunny day, as if fate intervened when a teacher from Educo Bridge School crossed paths with Sumaiya's mother. The teacher informed her about the free education services

offered by the school. Initially hesitant, Sumaiya's mother wrestled with the decision, torn between her desire to provide her daughter with an education and the pressing need for Sumaiya's income. Assuring Sumaiya's mother that her daughter's education would not hinder their immediate needs, the teacher convinced her to allow Sumaiya to attend school. Determined to seize the opportunity, she embraced an unconventional routine, studying at night when the world around her was enveloped in silence.

I cannot feel pain in my fingertips, they are not aching at all, which was unbearable when I first started working.

I know that education is my ladder to a brighter future, and I believe that with determination, I can break the cycle of poverty and pursue my dream.



Combat gender-based violence

At Educo, we are committed to challenging harmful social norms that perpetuate gender inequality and condone violence as a form of discipline. Our work spans across various regions of the country, aiming to eradicate gender-based violence by engaging children, adolescents, and youth (CA&Y) as powerful agents of societal transformation.

Educo has successfully oriented thousands of adolescents and youth in project areas, equipping them with the knowledge and understanding of non-violent masculinities. Through life skills and gender training, many individuals have gained valuable insights into the importance and benefits of gender equality.

Our efforts extend beyond direct engagement with CA&Y. We have also reached out to the wider community, empowering individuals with increased awareness and knowledge of gender-based violence prevention through targeted campaigns. These adolescents and youth, now equipped with knowledge and understanding, are actively sharing their insights and raising awareness among their peer groups through regular club and courtyard sessions.





Three promising football champs!

Despite the prevailing gender stereotypes and social stigma that discourage girls from participating in sports, especially in male-dominated football, Shrabonti Hasda, Monika Tudu, and Akhi Soren determined girls from an indigenous village in Godagari Upazila, Rajshahi District, have defied the odds. They have actively taken part in secondary school football competitions and achieved victory at the divisional level by becoming champions in both upazila and zilla school competitions.

Overcoming stereotypes and facing taunts within the Indigenous community of Bangladesh, these young girls continue to pursue their passion for football in Rajshahi District. Engaging in interactive training programmes, awareness sessions, and other events, they have come to understand the significance of sports for their physical and mental well-being. In addition to that the training in life skills has equipped them with teamwork, self-confidence, and leadership abilities, empowering them to tackle

life's challenges with resilience.

Through a collaborative effort between Sachetan Society and Educo Bangladesh, these girls have received 40 days of football training as part of the Educo Adolescents and Youth Empowerment programme. Their exceptional skills were evident during their participation in the secondary school football competition, where they excelled at the divisional level, earning the title of champions in both the upazila and zilla school competitions. Out of 58 players in total, three are currently playing at the divisional level, and one has even advanced to the national level.

Shrabonti's determination has led her and her team to success. As the best goalkeeper, she has been selected for the main team consisting of the finest players from all divisions, and she will represent Bangladesh in the Asian continent in 2023. Today, Shrabonti Hasda is not just a source of pride for Rajshahi but for the entire nation of Bangladesh.

Football is my dream, and Educo has guided me in making it come true. I am forever grateful to Educo and my coach.



Protecting children in humanitarian crises

We are dedicated to addressing the urgent needs of children and adolescents in crises and disasters. Our approach focuses on strengthening Education in Emergency (EiE), ensuring protection and well-being, and empowering them to combat violence and discrimination. We strengthen community-based child protection mechanisms, offering support to children and adolescents, and establishing tailored case management systems for Rohingya children and youth. Furthermore, Educo provides equitable access to protection and learning facilities, enabling Rohingya children to thrive.

Educo recognises the immense impact of natural and human-induced disasters on children and youth. Through our interventions, we contribute to reducing human suffering in these challenging circumstances. By promoting resilience and fostering more robust communities, both in camps and host communities, we empower children and youth to recover and develop themselves. For us, education remains a priority, even in emergencies. To achieve our objectives, Educo collaborates closely with children, adolescents, and youth (CA&Y), caregivers, formal and informal teachers, religious leaders, and local community representatives, along with other stakeholders.

So far, we have reached **29,144** participants, including **5,200** children **9,660** adolescents, **400** youth and **13,890** adults. We reached more than **62,700** indirect beneficiaries. Besides, we have established **106** adolescent clubs, **117** Community-Based Child Protection Committees (CBCPC) and **42** Community-Based Learning Facilities (CBLF) and our work extends to six camps and five unions in Cox's Bazar.





Safiqui's journey of hope and empowerment

Safiqui Islam, at just three years old, he tragically lost his father to the violence of Myanmar's military army in 2017. With his mother and his siblings, Safiqui sought shelter in Bangladesh to escape the turmoil and settled in the Rohingya Camp 17, Kutupalong, Block-A. They left behind a life of relative comfort with their farmland in Myanmar, and now, they face challenging circumstances.

Safiqui was born with congenital physical and mental disabilities, making it difficult for him to express his emotions and communicate with others. This led to feelings of loneliness and distress, compounded by the mockery he endured from some in the community. He believed that his disability was a form of punishment, adding to his struggles.

In April 2022, Educo Bangladesh's Multi-Purpose Learning Center (MPC) team, including a Burmese language instructor, visited their block for a student survey. They identified children who were not attending any learning centers and those staying at home, like Safiqui. With the support of the block leaders, Safiqui was enrolled as a student in Educo's

Community-Based Learning Facility (CBLF) center.

Life began to change for Safiqui at the CBLF centre. Under the guidance of a dedicated Burmese language instructor, he started learning with enthusiasm and care. Safiqui can now read, write, and count numbers. He has the opportunity to play with his friends, who provide him with support and understanding. The days of isolation are gone; Safiqui feels accepted and valued within the community.

Educo's CBLF sessions go beyond academics. Safiqui now has knowledge about essential topics like hygiene, child abuse, child labor, child marriage, physical and sexual abuse, and girls' education. He has become aware of how to stay safe and make responsible choices in life. Safiqui's mother, Tahena, also actively participates in parenting meetings organised by Educo.

a person with a disability should not be considered a barrier to society, as long as everyone receives equal support.



Empowerment and agency for social change

We are dedicated to empowering children, adolescents, and youth (CA&Y) across the nation. Our Adolescents and Youth Empowerment programme aims to enable CA&Y from diverse regions to exercise their right to participation and facilitates life skills training to equip them with social and interpersonal skills required to develop the ability to make informed decisions. Besides, we provide technical and vocational training to mitigate the gap between demand and supply by providing marketable skills that can be applied immediately in the workplace. Moreover, it unlocks the door for harnessing economic empowerment, particularly among girls and young women which is another approach to tackle gender-based inequalities and violence.

Under this programmatic area we work for

- › **Organisation and agency for social change**
- › **Education and action for the ecological transition/climate change adaptation**

Organisation and agency for social change

To provide a nurturing environment for CA&Y, Educo Bangladesh has established **310** Adolescent and Youth Clubs (AYCs) within local communities including Cox's Bazar. These AYCs, equipped with resource centres, serve as safe spaces where CA&Y can freely exchange knowledge and experiences. Our focus on life skills education has empowered **25,000** CA&Y to find their voice, make choices, and actively participate in personal and social decision-making. Additionally, we have raised awareness about climate change and encouraged youth-led initiatives to promote an eco-friendly environment.

Recognising the transformative power of sports, we have motivated **4,000** Adolescents and Youth (A&Y) through our Sports for Development (S4D) programme, promoting self-improvement and personal growth. Furthermore, we have facilitated trade training for **420** AYC members, equipping them with valuable technical skills. As a result, **295** A&Y individuals have successfully engaged in income-generating activities, fostering economic independence.





Moving forward: Anamika's journey as a successful dairy entrepreneur



“

I dream of selling dairy products online to reach a larger audience.

”

Anamika, a 24-year-old entrepreneur, has a passion to work independently. A few years back, she started a new journey by investing in a livestock farm, and over the years, her dream has grown bigger. She not only makes a profit with this but also cares about animal welfare. So, she ensures that her animals are fed nutritious food and are given regular health checkups. With the support of ESDO, Educo's partner, she has implemented various farming techniques to improve the quality and quantity of milk produced by her livestock. Moreover, she secured a loan

from the government to efficiently manage her ventures.

The dairy products of her farm have gained popularity in the local market due to their high quality and freshness. Anamika's success as an entrepreneur has inspired many other young women in her village to take up farming as a career.



Education and action for the ecological transition/climate change adaptation

We are dedicated to empowering children and youth with the knowledge and tools necessary to adapt to the impacts of climate change. Our efforts include conducting actionable social research to identify solutions for climate-affected communities. Additionally, we are implementing youth-led climate change projects in Shariatpur, Barguna, and Sathkhira.

Till now, we have formed and sensitised three youth groups comprising **100** members each in these districts. These groups actively engage in raising awareness and promoting understanding of climate change and its implications for the environment. Furthermore, we have oriented **100** farmers on new and viable climate change adaptation technologies, fostering sustainable agricultural practices.

In line with our vision of sensitising youth and communities to adopt environmentally friendly behaviors, we have initiated the establishment of three eco-model villages across three sub-districts. These villages serve as exemplars of ecological transition, showcasing alternative solutions to adapt to climate change.

Through these initiatives, we aim to empower youth and community members to actively participate in climate change adaptation. By fostering a sense of environmental stewardship and promoting sustainable practices, we strive to create resilient communities capable of addressing the challenges posed by climate change.



Planting hope: Kajol Begaum's climate-resilient garden

“

My garden has become an attraction for all the women in our community. I inspire and empower them to embrace integrated, smart, and climate-resilient technology, just like I have, to earn a sustainable income.

”

Kajol Begaum faced numerous challenges due to her spouse's meager income as a day labourer in the Thermal Power Station. Struggling to make ends meet and provide a better life for her two sons, she felt burdened by financial constraints and limited opportunities. However, her life took a positive turn when she heard about the Grow Green to Protect Planet (G2P) Project, which aimed to form an agriculture group in the Sekanderkhali village.

Kajol attended the group formation meeting where she learned about the prevalent issues in the local agriculture sector, such as salinity, tidal surges, and cyclones disrupting crop production. She expressed her keen interest in joining the agriculture group and participated in a two-day training session on climate adaptive technology, organised by NSS and supported by Educo Bangladesh. The training, conducted by the Upazila agriculture officer, provided valuable insights into climate change, climate adaptive technology, and ecological

agriculture practices suitable for the village's unique challenges.

Motivated by the training and the support from the project, Kajol decided to pursue seedless lemon cultivation using Surjan technology, known for its resilience to salinity, tidal surges, and cyclones. She prepared her land and planted fifty seedless lemon saplings alongside vegetables, gourd, and sweet pumpkin.

Kajol's hard work bore fruit as her garden flourished, yielding a bountiful harvest of vegetables and healthy seedless lemons. She began selling her produce to generate income while ensuring her family enjoyed nutritious meals. Her determination to secure a better future for her children inspired her to dream big.



Advocacy, networking and collaboration

Our primary and overarching advocacy goals revolve around establishing and upholding the rights of children. We are dedicated to elimination of hazardous child labour, forming a dedicated directorate focused on children's issues, ensuring access to quality education, and fostering a safe environment by mitigating violence against children. We firmly believe in the power of collaborative advocacy rather than individual efforts.

In our efforts to collaborate with the government, we engage in producing evidence-based studies and reports concerning Child Rights. Furthermore, we implement advocacy initiatives on both local and national scales, utilising social mobilisation and media campaigns to uphold children's rights in various domains.

Our active participation is evident in our membership within numerous global and national alliances and networks. These include prominent entities like Joining Force-CRN! Rights Now, Girls Not Bride, CAMPE, Child Rights Advocacy Coalition in Bangladesh, National Girl Child Advocacy Forum, Citizens Platform for SDGs Bangladesh, and GBV Cluster.

Our constructive relationships extend to key governmental bodies, such as the Parliamentary Caucus on Child Rights, Ministry of Labour and Employment, and Ministry of Women and Children Affairs. We also play an integral role as members of diverse child rights-focused committees under these ministries, collaboratively commemorating national and international occasions under their leadership.



Implementing partners



Development partners





Dreams come true

The foundation of dreams and success



Muhammad Yasin Bhuian

“

I extend my heartfelt gratitude to you for being the bedrock of my growth, the wellspring of my knowledge, and the sanctuary of my cherished memories. You will forever occupy a special place in my heart, and I will carry your essence as a guiding light in all my endeavours. May my old school thrive and continue to shape the lives of countless others like me. Thank you all, from the bottom of my heart.

”

Yasin, who recently achieved 3.6 GPA in his MBA on Banking and Insurance from Dhaka University with a commendable second highest score of his class, nurtures a dream of becoming the governor of Bangladesh Bank. His journey began in 2004 when he joined Educo Pathshala Shahjadpur in pre-primary grade. Throughout his academic life, from primary to secondary grades, Educo Pathshala provided support, and the connection continued even during his university years.

Yasin, filled with deep appreciation, reflected on his time at Educo School, declaring, "My beloved Educo Pathshala, where I received my first lessons, holds a deep-rooted place in

my heart. As I reminisce about those invaluable years, memories of laughter, learning, and enduring friendships flood my mind."

To Yasin, Educo Pathshala was far more than a mere structure; it served as a haven where dreams flourished, young minds were shaped, and the seeds of the future were sown. Within its classrooms, he embarked on each day with eager steps and a hopeful heart, encountering fresh challenges and absorbing valuable life lessons. The teachers went beyond academics; they acted as mentors and guardians, always recognising his potential even when self-doubt arose.

The leader of the community



Setumoni

“

As a responsible human being, I am enthusiastic about creating a positive impact and giving back to the community. In pursuit of this goal, I became a member of the Educo Bangladesh Adolescent and Youth Club, where I have proudly taken on the role of President. This club is dedicated to nurturing the mental and physical well-being of young individuals. Our efforts encompass providing life skills and organise a diverse range of activities aimed at fostering their leadership abilities and promoting effective teamwork.

”

In addition to her studies and club activities, Setumoni joined the Computer Club at her former university, University of Information and Technology and Science, and worked as a BD Apps Developer, which helped boost her self-confidence. Currently, she is working as a software quality assurance intern in a software company.

Since Setumoni's childhood, she had a strong desire to become an engineer, but financial constraints in her family caused her to put that dream on hold. Nonetheless, Educo played a critical role by giving constant encouragement and support that have opened new doors and opportunities to reach her goal.

In 2007, she was admitted to "Intervida Pathshala Panchkhola," a school in her village. Due to the financial constraints in her family and the lack of proper educational facilities in their village, obtaining a quality education seemed like an unattainable dream for many bright and economically disadvantaged students like her. However, the presence of Intervida School opened up new possibilities for underprivileged students, providing them with the opportunity to excel in their studies. This school served as the foundation of her journey towards fulfilling her aspirations. Later on, she became affiliated with the rebranded NGO of Intervida, known as "Educo Pathshala Panchkhola," which further enhanced her educational and professional experiences.

Shohag's path to healing the underprivileged



Shohag

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Educo went beyond providing academic assistance and also extended support in times of physical illness, I could access to necessary medical care from pre-primary to fifth grade in primary school. The organisation's caring and comprehensive support didn't stop there; it played a crucial role in helping me achieve my dream to be a doctor.

”

Shohag had a passion for medicine and a strong desire to become a doctor, to heal the sick and alleviate suffering. However, his dreams were overshadowed by the harsh reality of his family's financial situation. Despite facing financial challenges, he never wavered in his determination to become a doctor. With the support of his family and the foundation laid by Educo, he worked tirelessly to secure a seat in the prestigious Dhaka Medical College, and finally got admitted in 2023.

Educo, the organisation, which had been with him from his pre-primary days, extended their hand to ensure that his dream of becoming a doctor was achieved. His life took a turn from then. The organisation recognised

Shohag's potential and provided him with vital support to continue his education. The assistance he received from Educo, including access to quality education, study materials, and a nurturing environment, instilled in him the confidence to dream big. Moreover, they provided financial assistance to cover his college fees and other expenses, giving him the much-needed encouragement to continue his journey.

With each passing day, Shohag grew not only as a medical student but also as a compassionate individual. The struggles he faced during his journey only fueled his passion to make a difference in the lives of others.

Popi Rani, the dedicated police officer



Popi Rani

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The assistance I have received from Educo will forever etched in my heart.

”

Popi Rani, a proud police officer, has dedicated her life to serving and helping others. However, her journey was not easy, given the financial instability faced by her and her family. At the age of 5, Popi Rani started on her educational journey at Fundacion Intervida School in Talab, a pre-primary school later renamed Educo School Talab. With the backing of Educo, Popi Rani continued her studies, receiving valuable support in the form of free study materials, school uniform, toys, and a daily balanced lunch.

In 2012, Popi Rani succeeded in her Primary School Certificate (PSC) exams, but her family faced financial challenges that hindered her enrollment in higher secondary

school. Thankfully, the headmaster, Ram Lal Barman, assured her family that Educo would cover the expenses of her higher education. As a result, Popi Rani continued her academic pursuit at Priyababu Mallikbari Shahid Nazim Uddin High School.

Despite her father's wish to marry her off after completing her SSC, Popi Rani clung to her dream of becoming a police officer. With crucial support from her mother, Joddha Rani, she held on to her educational aspirations. In 2019, after passing her Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC) exams, Popi Rani fulfilled her dream and joined the Bangladesh Police. Currently, she proudly serves at Kona Bari Police Station in Gazipur district.

Mamun's unstoppable journey with Educo Bangladesh



Mamun

“

Educo is more than just an organisation; it has been the gateway that unlocked a world of knowledge and endless possibilities

”

In the heart of Joypurhat, there lived a child named Mamun, whose life revolved around hardship. In 2001, he moved to Dhaka with his parents, seeking a glimmer of hope in a harsh world. Despite the uncertainty of the future, Mamun's determination illuminated even the darkest days. At the tender age of 11, he shouldered the burden of his family's needs and embarked on a challenging journey, labouring tirelessly in a Silver Factory at Shyampur, earning a meager BDT 30 per day.

Amidst his struggles, a hope emerged to resume his education when his friend, Khokon, introduced him to Educo (formerly known as Intervida Bangladesh). Determined to grasp the opportunity, he devoted his evenings from 5:00 PM to 8:00 PM to study, enrolling in the Educo Working Children School Shyampur in 2003.

Educo supported his Education till 2006. Then in the same year, Mamun's life took a turn when Educo provided him vocational training on candle making, including a candle making machine. This contribution discovered a new world to him, steering him towards a path of self-sufficiency.

In 2007, Mamun joined Educo as an external vendor, providing essential food items to the school. The next year marked the beginning of his professional journey with Educo, where he became a Distribution Personnel in the Store Department. Over time, he has progressed to the role of Assistant Officer in the Administration division of Educo. To Mamun, Educo is more than just an organisation; it has been the gateway that unlocked a world of knowledge and endless possibilities.

The tale of Prasanjit's success



Prasanjit

“

Educo not only helped in my studies but also enabled me to achieve my dreams by providing financial support.

”

In 2016, Prasanjit achieved success by scoring high marks in his Secondary School Certificate (SSC) examination. Though his father encouraged him to pursue a traditional career for stability, he compelled to join in law enforcement agency to serve the nation. After discovering his passion for law enforcement, he embarked on a journey with the Bangladesh Police Force. Currently stationed at Hobiganj Thana in Sylhet District, he serves the community with dedication and pride.

Similar to his fellow students at Intervida school, Prasanjit faced challenges in his past. With his father working as a labourer and his mother facing limited financial opportunities, their days were filled with difficulties. Nevertheless, at the age of 5, he

received crucial support to continue his education from "Fundacion Intervida School Nayanpur," later known as Educo School Nayanpur. Throughout his academic journey, from elementary school to SSC, Educo remained a constant source of support and assistance for him.



Jalal Mia

From vegetable seller to engineer: fulfilling a childhood dream

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Educo's support made my dream of becoming an engineer a reality; otherwise, it would have been nothing more than a distant hope. Perhaps I would have been limited to selling vegetables or doing undignified jobs to survive. After completing my studies, my aspiration is to give back to society and make a difference in the lives of children like myself.

”

Jalal Mia, currently studying in the final year of the Department of Building Engineering and Construction Management (BECM) at Rajshahi University of Engineering and Technology (RUET), is pursuing his dream of becoming an engineer. However, his journey towards this was not smooth.

Due to his father's illness and two surgeries, they had to sell all their land to cover the expenses. The doctor stated that his father can no longer work. In 2004, the family moved to Dhaka for survival. His mother, sister, and elder brother became domestic helpers, while he worked in a vegetable shop. Their earnings supported the family but providing education for all five siblings seemed unattainable.

One day, a madam visited the vegetable shop and emphasised the importance of education. With a heavy heart, he expressed his sorrow,

explaining that poverty made it nearly impossible for him to study. The madam insisted that he must join the "Intervida Working Children School Shahjadpur," where he could study alongside his work. Moreover, she passionately detailed the benefits, promising free access to various books, notebooks, pens, and pencils. Overwhelmed with joy, we embraced this opportunity. With my father's support, I was enrolled in the infant class in 2006, and I witnessed two more friends being admitted to the school, Jalal stated this.

While balancing work, he continued his studies with the assistance of dedicated teachers. Since childhood, he nurtured a long-cherished dream of becoming an engineer. Even if any reason he could not attend the school, the teachers would visit their homes to provide guidance and encourage regular attendance.



Thank you message!

On this special occasion celebrating Educo's 25th anniversary, we want to take a moment to express our heartfelt gratitude and appreciation to all of you who have been a part of our journey. Your dedication, hard work, and commitment have been the driving force behind our success and the transformative impact we have achieved in the lives of children and communities throughout Bangladesh.

The strength of our team lies in the diverse talents and expertise each of you brings to the table. Whether it is your exceptional project management skills, creativity in designing educational programmes, tireless efforts in fundraising, or dedication to building strong

partnerships, every contribution has been invaluable in advancing Educo's mission.

We would also like to extend our sincere appreciation to our participants and their families, partners, donors, and well-wishers, Govt and non-govt stakeholders, alliances, likeminded organisations. Your trust in our work and your generous contributions have allowed us to expand our reach, implement impactful projects, and empower communities. It is through our collective efforts that we have been able to create tangible opportunities for children to thrive and succeed.





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